

VISUAL SUMMARY

Startup Success, Decoded

An analysis of 1,000 businesses to see exactly what makes them succeed, fail, or sell.



Succeed

Enterprise stability and high-value customer contracts.



Fail

High churn from SMBs creating a constant 'leaky bucket' effect.

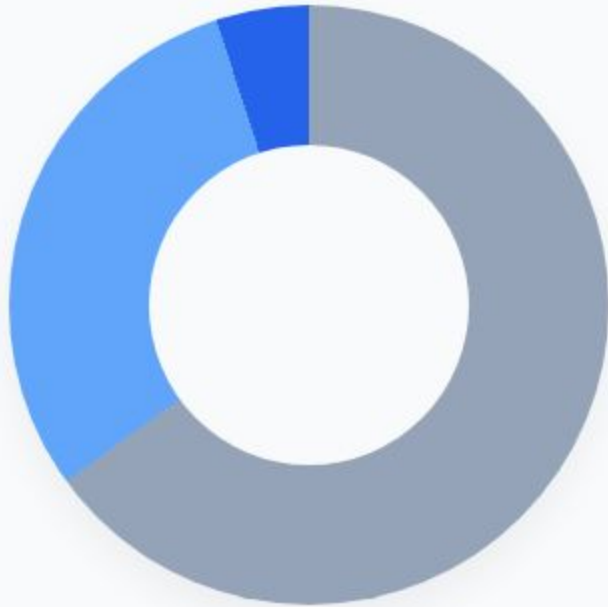


Sell

Strategic exits, SaaS acquisitions, and founder liquidity events.

What is TrustMRR?

The 1,000 Startups Tracked



■ Micro-Startups (Under \$1k/mo)

■ Scaling Businesses (\$1k - \$100k/mo)

■ Market Leaders (Over \$100k/mo)

A window into real startup finances.

TrustMRR is a platform that tracks and verifies the actual financial performance of software businesses and startups.

For this report, we analyzed a dataset of exactly **1,000 companies** listed on their platform. This gives us a rare, highly transparent look at real numbers that are usually kept secret.

The dataset tracks everything from Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR) and active subscriptions, to the pricing models they use and whether the company is actively looking for a buyer.

1. The Revenue Gap

Top Earning Startups

Monthly Revenue Comparison



A few giants take home most of the money.

When you look at all 1,000 startups combined, they make a massive **\$13.4 million** every month. However, that number is highly deceptive as wealth is incredibly concentrated at the very top.

The Top Performer

Just one single company makes over **\$3.5 million a month**, completely dwarfing the runners-up.

The Median Startup

If you line up all the companies and look at the one exactly in the middle, they are only making **\$282 a month**.

2. Customer Size Matters

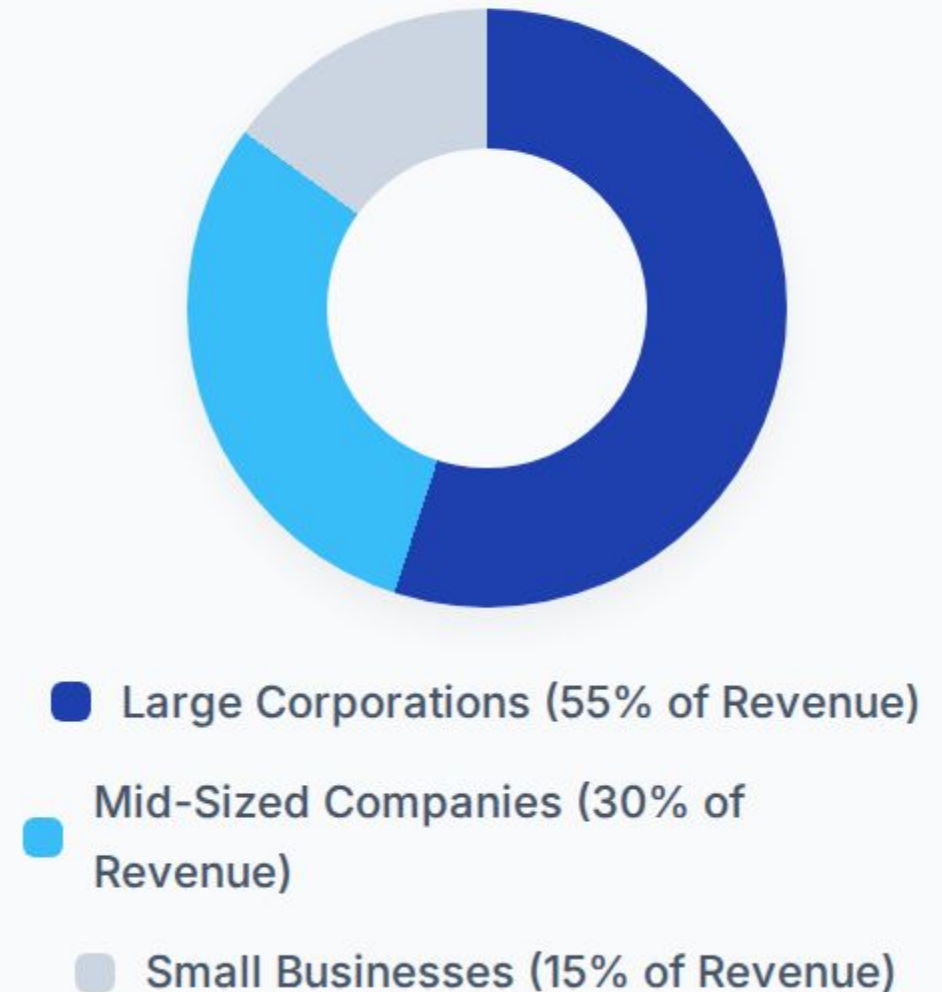
Who actually pays the bills?

Most of the startups in this list cater to small businesses and everyday consumers. In fact, 70% of the customer accounts in this dataset belong to small users.

But here is the catch: those small users only generate **15% of the total revenue**.

The real money comes from "Enterprise" clients (large corporations). Even though large corporations make up just **8% of the customer base**, they are responsible for bringing in more than half of all the money.

Where the Revenue Comes From



3. The "Leaky Bucket" Problem

Monthly Cancellation Rate

Percentage of customers who leave each month

Small Biz

8.5% leave

Mid-Sized

4.2% leave

Large Corps

1.1% leave

Why is it so hard to grow?

Startups that rely on small businesses face a massive hurdle: their customers cancel constantly.

Every single month, **8.5% of small business customers cancel** their software subscriptions. This creates a "leaky bucket" where founders have to work incredibly hard just to replace the customers they lost yesterday.

In contrast, large corporations rarely cancel once they sign up (only **1.1% leave each month**). This makes their revenue highly stable and predictable.

4. The Rush to Sell

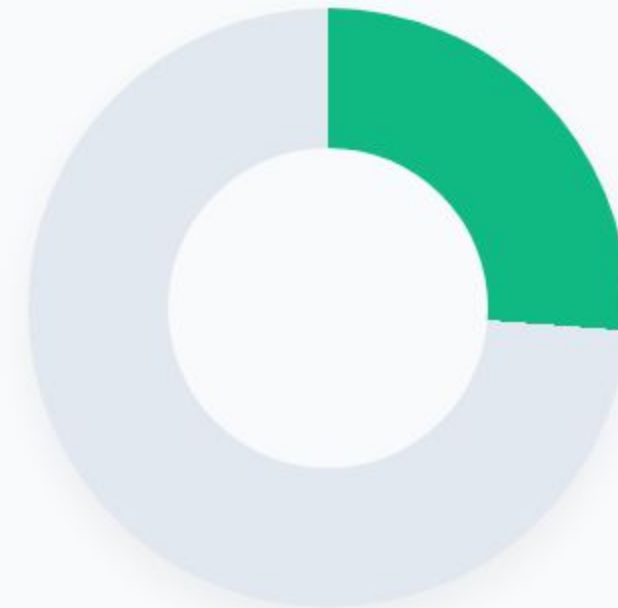
Founders want to cash out.

Building and maintaining a software company is exhausting work, especially for the hundreds of smaller companies fighting for survival.

Because of this fatigue, a surprisingly high number of startups are actively looking for someone to buy them. Right now, **over a quarter (26%)** of all the businesses in this dataset are up for sale.

This creates a huge opportunity for investors to swoop in, buy struggling software tools at a discount, and improve them.

Startups Currently For Sale



■ Actively For Sale (26%)

■ Not For Sale (74%)

In Conclusion: The Playbook



1. Look Past the Average

Don't be fooled by high average revenue numbers. The reality is that the vast majority of startups are barely scraping by, while a select few make millions.



2. Build for Big Business

If you want a stable, profitable company, build software for medium and large corporations. They pay more, and they rarely cancel their subscriptions.



3. Buy, Don't Build

With 26% of these startups looking for a way out, the smartest move for an entrepreneur right now might be to buy an existing business rather than starting from scratch.